

lending industry. It's all about them. Abe Lincoln may be rolling around in his grave, but we do not need to roll over. We need to remind the government who they really work for.

Partners in Crime

There are many infuriating examples of how the American citizen is being taken advantage of by the partnership of big business and big government. I'll hit on some of these deceitful practices a bit more in depth as we go, but let me mention just a few of these offensive acts that immediately come to mind.

1. Bankruptcies are at an all-time high. It makes sense. The debt is rampant. People are out of work or have medical emergencies or a death in the family, and they can't pay off their debt; they assume that bankruptcy is the only way out. Nearly one out of every fifty households in the United States files bankruptcy. Instead of trying to treat the root cause of the problem and address the real issue – why the debt is so high that people are forced to such extreme measures – the government tightened up the bankruptcy laws.

In 2005, the feds made it harder for people to file bankruptcy. Does this help the individual citizen? Not at all. Who does it help? The banks and the credit card companies. If a person files bankruptcy, the banker boys don't get paid. So the bankers went to their buddies in Washington and got them to change the law. For some people, bankruptcy was their only protection from the predatory practices of the lenders, and now that protection is much less. How I see it: I give a guy some money, and then he does a favor for me. In some circles, that could be called a bribe.

2. Who is in control? You need to know up front that the number one reason that debt is out of control in America is because the lenders are out of control, NOT the spenders. Do you have high credit card debt? Most of us carry some debt. If you are among the millions of hard working bill-paying people who cannot pay off the balance each month, that is where they get you. Their devilish ploy is to keep you trapped so you *cannot* pay off your debt in full. The fees ring up when you have a balance, and that is music to their ears.